Millen Woods School Council

Meeting Minutes — September 16, 2026

1. Welcome and Introductions

- **Meeting called to order:** 6:40 PM by Jake.
- **Attendance:** Recorded (see attached attendance sheet).
- **Land Acknowledgement:** Presented by Jake.
- **Agenda approval:** Motion to approve the October agenda by Lisa.
- **Previous minutes approval:** Motion to approve the September 2026 minutes by Dan.
- **Introductions:** New Council members and attendees introduced themselves.
- **Co-Chair:** Thank you to Lisa for stepping up to serve as Co-Chair.

2. News and Reports

Administration Report

- Bonnie was voted in as the staff representative
- Diana Kostakos-Murphy voted in as the teacher representative.
- $975 was raised.
- The Grade 2 reading club is underway.
- The Millen Cup Final took place.
- Volleyball is scheduled to begin next week.
- The new student announcement group is running and is expected to provide a great leadership opportunity for students.
- Office and lunch helper programs are running.
- Progress reports are being prepared.
- Five teacher candidates are at the school.
- The “Anything But a Backpack” day was successful.
- Two assemblies were held: a Welcome Assembly and an assembly recognizing Terry Fox and Orange Shirt Day.
- Student voting for Movie Night is underway.
- EQAO results are now available. Families are encouraged to review results for all Ontario schools and consider school, board, and provincial comparisons. Millen Woods performed above average across the board.
- The Gaga ball pit is awaiting approval from Facilities.

Finance Report

- $165 was spent on the Meet Community event.

    - Food and the book fair were the main income source.
    - The Scholastic account will be used by the library to support teachers and students.
- Popcorn sales generated $1,600.
- Grade 6 graduation expenses were reviewed.
- A 3D printer was purchased for $750.
- **Remaining balance:** $28,600.

School Council Composition and WRAPSC Report

- A community member position can be added to the School Council.
- WRAPSC provides an opportunity for school councils across the WRDSB to connect and share information.
- Jake attended the October 6, 2026 meeting.
- Topics included guidance on navigating school-related issues and learning from the experiences of other school councils.
- The next meeting is scheduled for November 3, 2026. All interested council members are welcome to attend.

3. Existing Business

Snack and Lunch Programs

- **Apples:** The extended-day program is supplementing resources. There is currently an abundance of apples remaining.
- **ESNS:** The program is going well, with positive feedback from students and parents.
- **Popcorn and ice cream sandwiches:**
    - Kindergarten students are having popcorn sent home due to safety precautions.
    - Equity concerns were raised regarding kindergarten students ordering ice cream sandwiches through Menchie's.
    - The Council discussed whether to cover the cost to ensure equitable access or make kindergarten students ineligible to order.
    - Concerns were raised about popcorn being stale. Serena confirmed that, to her knowledge, the popcorn is fresh.

Fundraising Calendar

- A placeholder week for the **Week of Giving** has been added, with staff currently expected to lead the initiative.
- The timing, potentially in December, needs to be confirmed.
- Serena will bring the idea to staff for discussion.
- The Council will explore whether parents can lead or support the initiative.
- Volunteers may be needed to assist with deliveries.

Movie Night — November 12, 2026

- Student voting is underway, with three movies being considered:
    - *Rumble*
    - *The SpongeBob Movie: Sponge on the Run*
    - *Butterfly Tale*
- Jake will manage the technical setup and conduct a run-through before the event.
- Food options will include pizza and popcorn.
- Pradeep will coordinate pizza orders.
- Pizza will be ordered by the whole pizza, with regular and gluten-free options. Pizza by the slice will also be considered.
- Ashley will place the popcorn order.

Cold Weather Clothing Drive — October 1–14, 2026

- The clothing drive ran successfully.
- A total of **42 winter coats** were donated.
- Karen Grant O'Grady will distribute clothing directly to students as needed.

4. New Business

PRO Grant

- The application deadline is November 20, 2026.
- Most applicants are reportedly receiving $500 this year, compared with $800 last year.
- The Council will prepare a general grant application that can be applied to a suitable event or vendor.
- The goal is to support parent and guardian engagement at school events.
- The Tinker Truck was identified as a potential option for a STEM activity: Tinker Truck.
- The Council will explore contacting ESQ regarding faculty outreach opportunities with the University of Waterloo.

Winter Wonderland — January 14, 2027

- The event is planned for Thursday, January 14, 2027.
- This will be a free event for the school community.
- Hot chocolate will be offered.
- Volunteers will be needed.
- Daniella has sourcing documents available, as noted by Kristen.
- Pradeep volunteered to join the planning committee.

Garden Clean-Up — Fall and Spring

- Joleen coordinated the fall clean-up.
- The previously approved budget was $500; less than $300 was spent.
- Despite cold and rainy weather, several families participated.
- Serena provided significant assistance.

- Bulbs were planted with and for Kindergarten and Grade 1 students.
- The proposed spring planting budget is $750, with $1,500 carried over.
- The parking lot garden may be converted into a pollinator garden.
- The Council will explore support from the Waterloo Region Nature Foundation and seek student volunteers.
- Donations of pollinator-friendly plants will also be explored.

Photo Day

- The Council previously decided to proceed with composite photos.
- Serena will look into whether composite photos can still be ordered; the process is currently with Ann.
- Since not every student had their photo taken, this may affect the composite photos.
- A potential retake date of November 17 was discussed.
- **Action:** Revisit the composite photo decision at the next meeting after retakes have taken place.

Picnic Tables for the Yard

- The Council discussed adding picnic tables to the schoolyard.
- The budget needs to be confirmed, along with whether a formal vote is required.
- Serena will investigate potential vendors and purchasing options.
- All options must meet the school board's safety requirements.
- Vandalism is a concern based on previous experience.
- The Council will explore whether local high school woodworking classes could build or donate benches, similar to the previous mud kitchen project with Huron Heights.
- Leftover wood from the garden beds may also be suitable for benches or other uses.

5. Adjournment

The meeting was adjourned at **7:35 PM**.

Next Meeting: December 9, 2026, at 6:30 PM (virtual only).

Thank you to everyone for contributing your time and effort to Millen Woods School Council! Your support helps strengthen our school community and create meaningful opportunities for our students.